5.5-5.8 Advanced Security

PART II

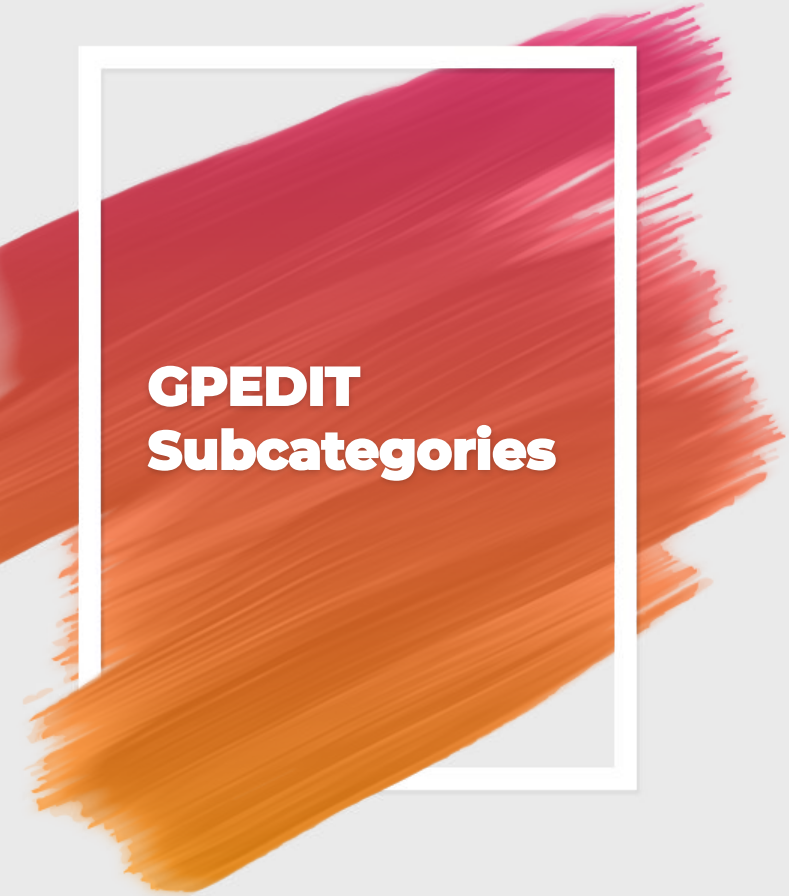
brought to you by clem, ceo of subway

5.5 GPEDIT in Depth

GPEDIT Categories

Computer Configuration

User Configuration



Software Settings

- Not a big concern

Windows Settings

- Includes LSP, firewall, startup/shutdown scripts

Administrative Templates

- The restrictive settings you all know and love

GPEDIT Administrative Templates

Sub-subcategories

- Control Panel
- Network
- Printers
- Server
- Start Menu and Taskbar
- System
- Windows Components

Sub sub categories in depth

Control Panel

Lock screen settings

Language and input

Other non important ones

Network

A bunch of network related settings

Important considerations include:

DNS

Network Connections (Firewall)

Printers

Printer settings

Server

Some backup settings

Sub sub categories in depth (cont.)

Start Menu and Taskbar

Start Menu and a tiny Notifications setting

Not really important

System

More interesting settings

Important considerations include:

Logon

Remote Assistance

Windows Components

Majority of security settings here

Recommended to check each subcategory for yourself

There's BitLocker, Internet Explorer, Windows Update, and much more

5.6 BitLocker

What is BitLocker?

Encrypts your hard drive

Set up requires a Trusted Platform Module

- Since not provided in VMs, you'll have to set a setting in GPEDIT to ignore that

Server versions require you to install the feature first

Where is the GPEDIT setting?

Windows Components > BitLocker Drive Encryption > Operating System Drives > Require additional authentication at startup

Enable it and check the “Allow BitLocker without a compatible TPM”

How to set up?

Windows search for BitLocker

You'll need to provide a password or a USB to gain access to the drive, and you'll be asked to set up a recovery key - use a USB or "fake print"

DO NOT MESS UP HERE!!! You may accidentally lock yourself out of your computer if you don't have the password/USB you used.

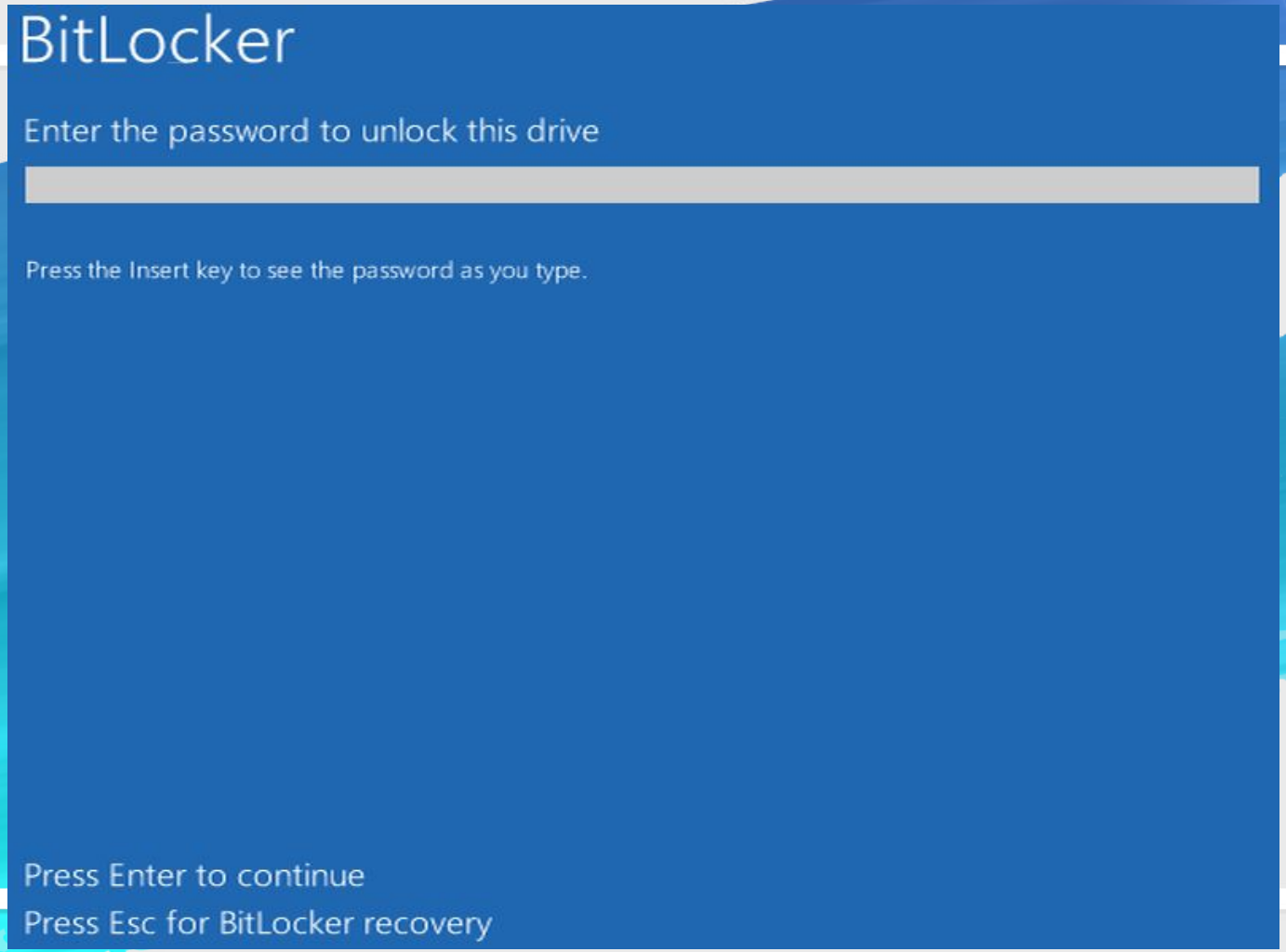
BitLocker setup

BitLocker will do its magic

After a while, you may be asked to restart to make changes

When restarting, you'll be greeted with a blue prompt if you chose the password route

Afterwards, you can log in to the computer normally


BitLocker
Enter the password to unlock this drive
Press the Insert key to see the password as you type.
Press Enter to continue
Press Esc for BitLocker recovery

5.7 Program Security

Programs have their individual security settings

Each program may come equipped with security settings that you can set to improve security



Most of the time, these settings are found by your own exploration.

Settings are generally found under Edit > Preferences - can vary

Google for the right place for settings

Online research alternative

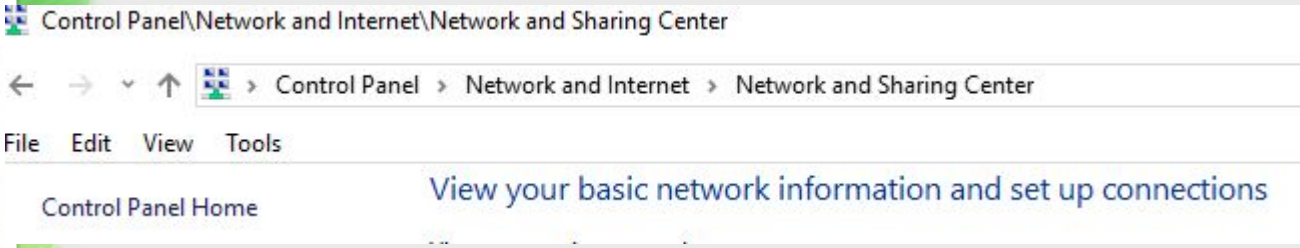
Many commonly used programs will have forums or some documentation outlining secure settings

Take advantage of these sites!

Ex: Google “Filezilla hardening”

5.8 Network Security

Network and Sharing Center

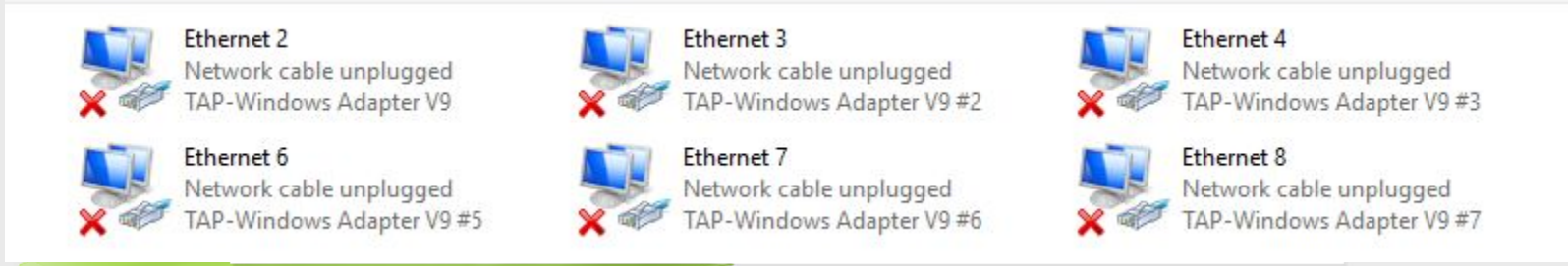


What is found here?

Network settings - WiFi, access type, connection method

You can change adapter settings and advanced settings

Adapter settings

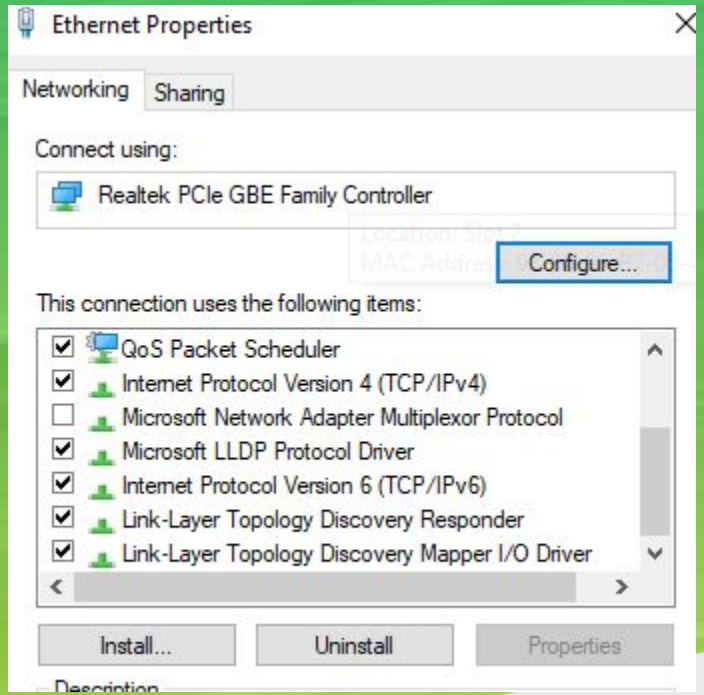


Adapters

You can configure which adapters are enabled/disabled for Internet connections

Checking the properties of an adapter will allow you to set settings for that

Adapter settings



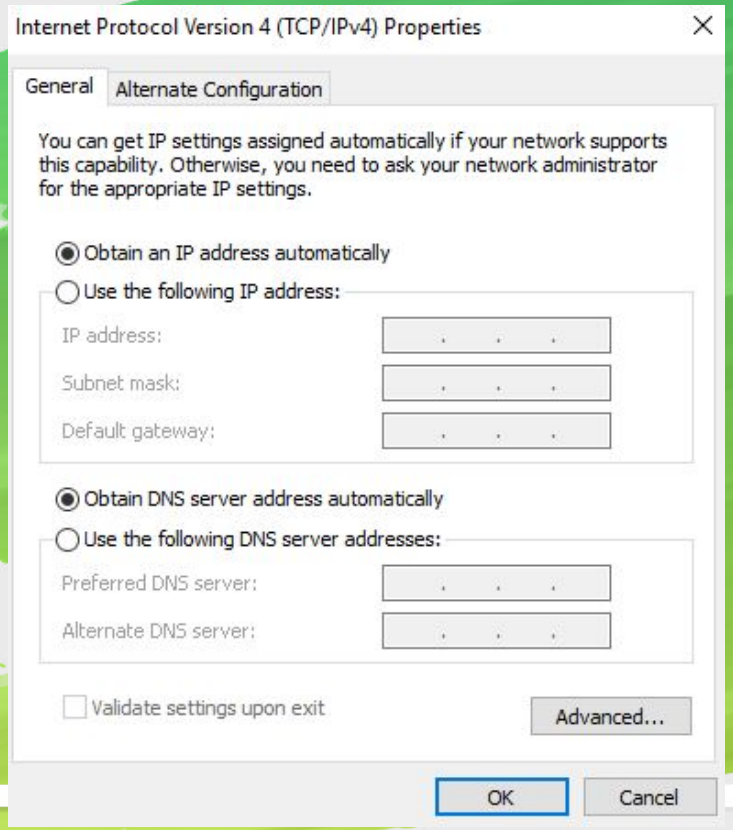
What to do?

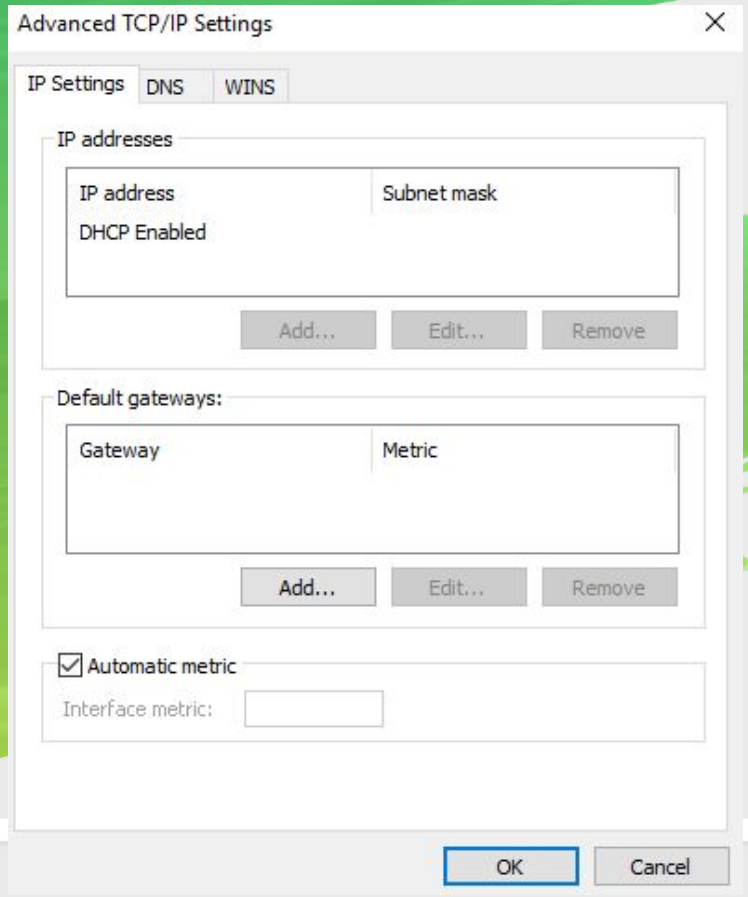
Install/uninstall connection items

- If you are unsure about this, it's better to not screw up your connection

Manage properties of connections

IPv4 Properties





What is this for?

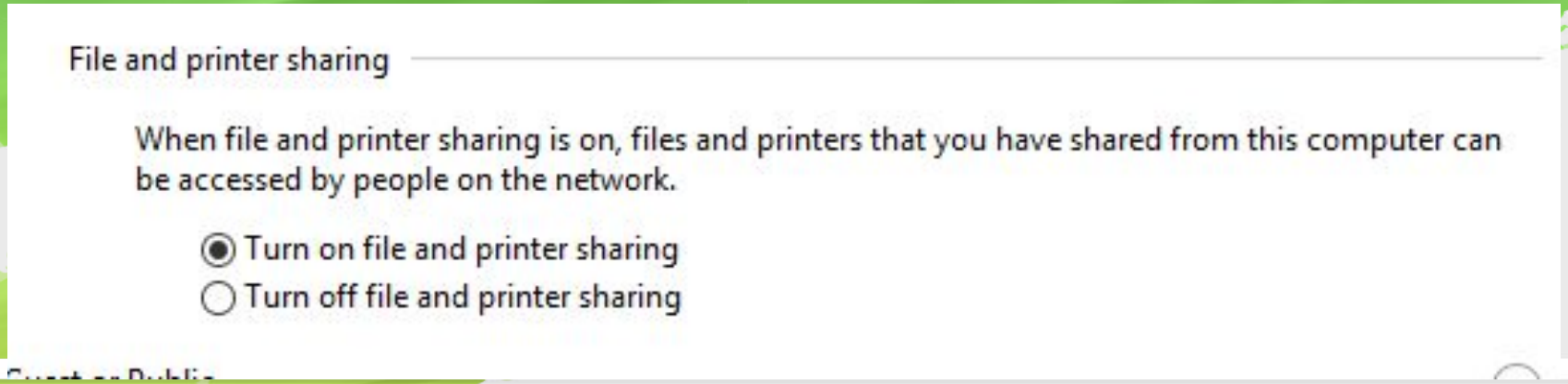
If you ever need to double-check or set IP addresses or DNS server addresses, here is where you go to

Advanced sharing settings

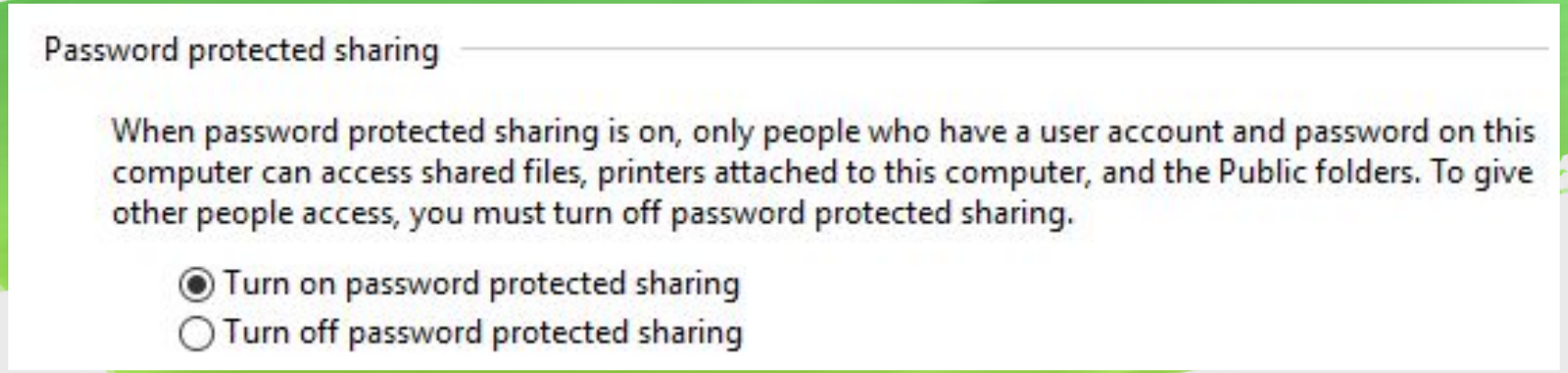
For each profile, configure the option that makes the most sense

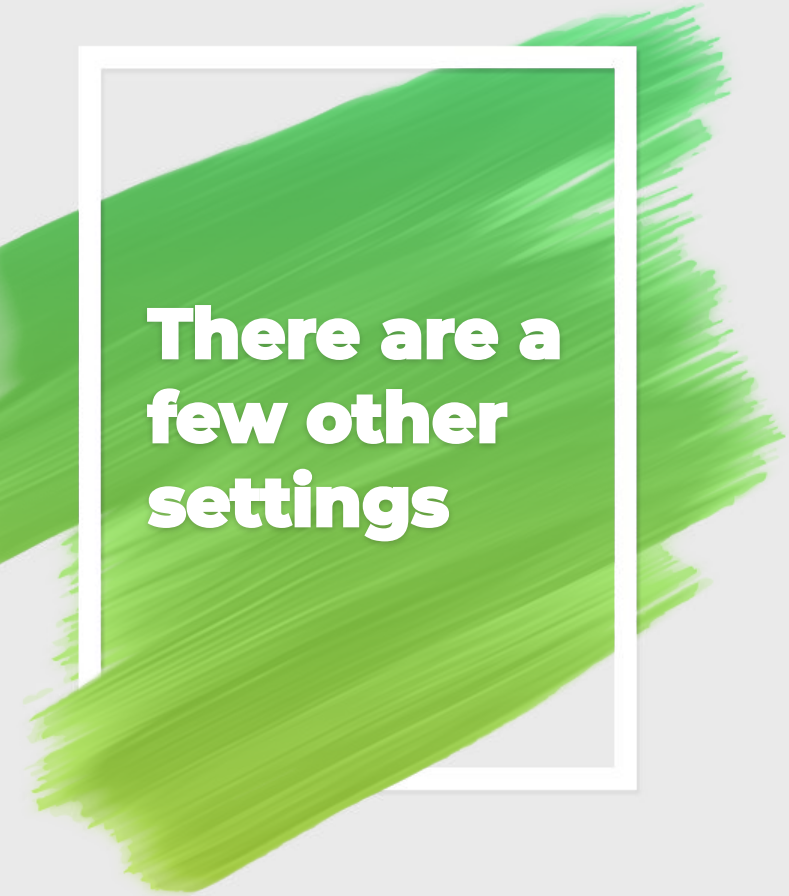
Most of these are common sense, don’t worry

Assuming no files are to be shared, is this setting correct?



To have a password or not to have one...?





Some settings even provide you the recommended choice

Simple configuration, no wacky settings here

End of Part II